Fishman Fellowship
Taubman College of Architecture and Urban Planning
University of Michigan

Portfolio of Work

Eric Rannestad

Eric Rannestad is a designer, researcher, and artist interested in the coproduction of landscape through environmental models, economy, and visual culture. The work draws on the language of maps, forecasting models, capital flows, technical instruments, and other site-specific artifacts to investigate themes of uncertainty, ground, and circulation. Eric combines media that span excavated arched sculptural components, watercolor surfaces, drawings, and and generative media: each a different cut in the interrelated forces that construct landscape, each offering a different register for locating oneself within these forces.

Eric lives and works in Cambridge, MA. He received a Master of Design Studies (MDes) from the Harvard Graduate School of Design and a BA in Studio Art and Economics from Whitman College. His work has been supported by grants from Artadia and Massachusetts Cultural Council, with fellowships from the Vermont Studio Center and I-Park Foundation and with residencies from the Sitka Center for Art and Ecology and the North Cascades Institute, among others. Eric's projects in cartography and experience working with environmental groups across the American West are a significant influence in his wider creative practice.

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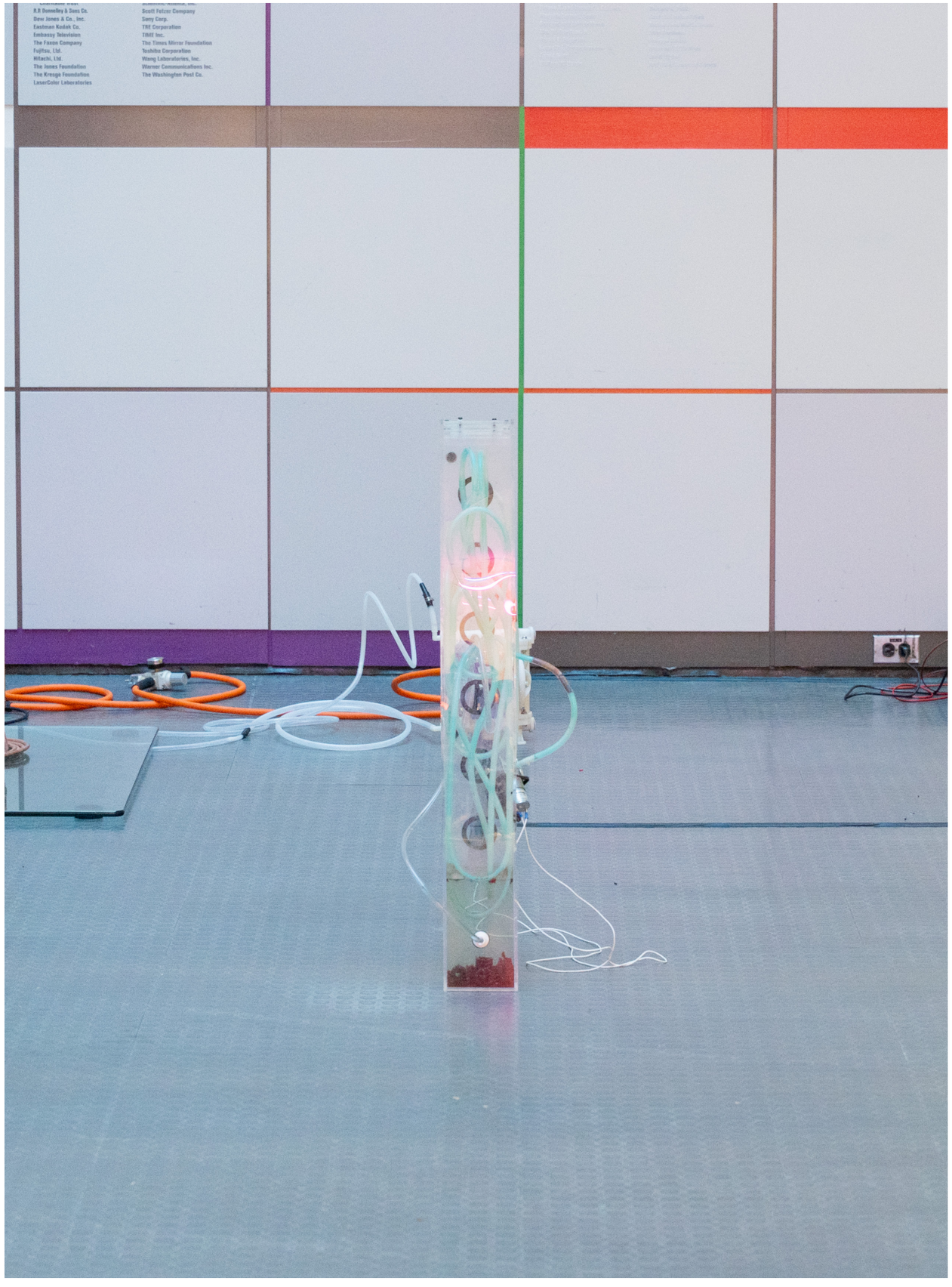
www.ericrannestad.com
ericrannestad@gsd.harvard.edu
ericrannestad@gmail.com



Accumulator 01 in *Tailings* installation view, MIT List Center for Visual Arts. 2025

Tailings
New and Old Metabolics in Butte, Montana

Artistic Research
Design Research

2025-26

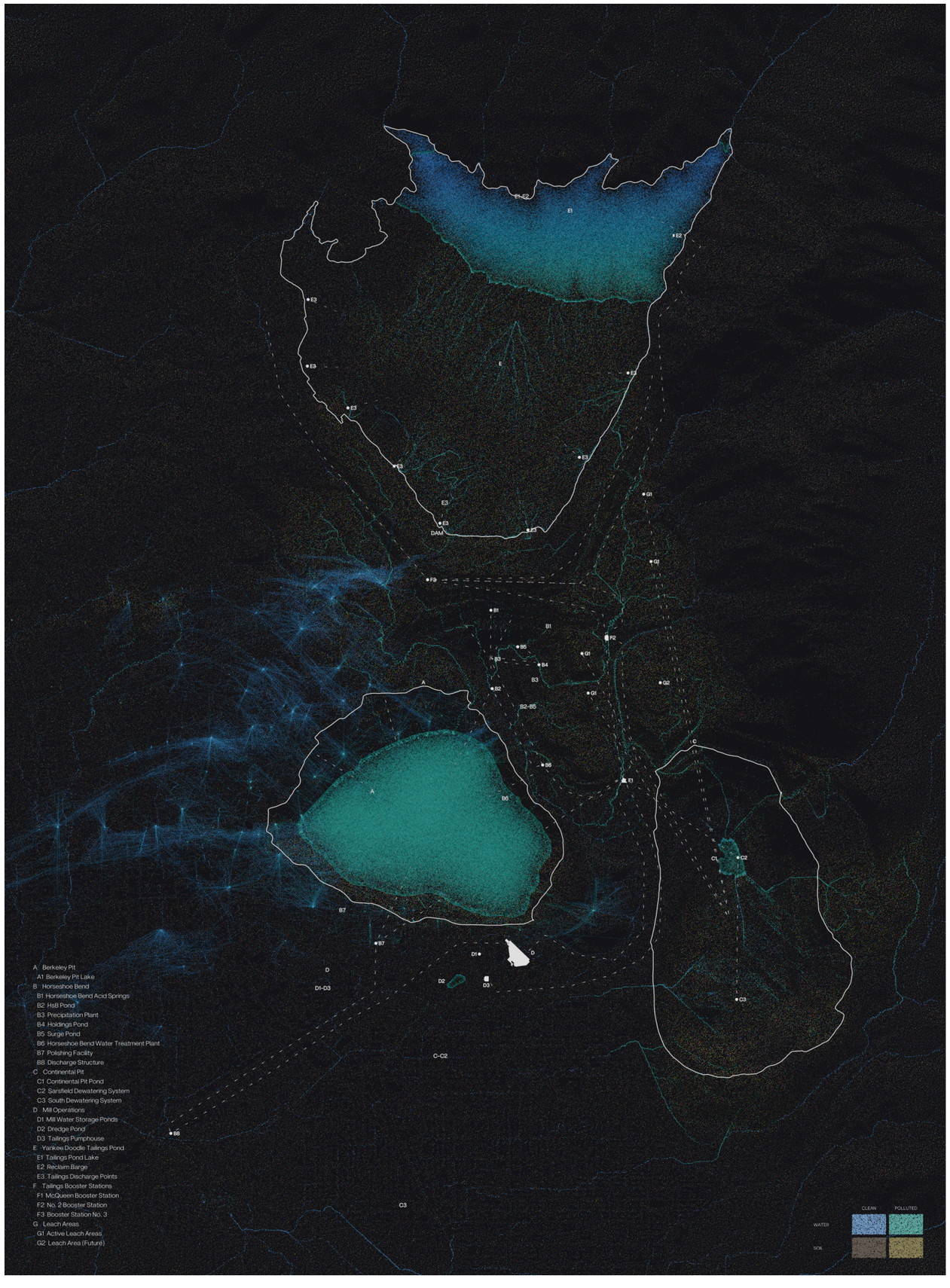
Accumulated mine tailings from centuries of copper, cobalt, and coal extraction are increasingly recognized by the United States government as latent deposits of rare earth elements—resources now critical to data centers, satellite infrastructure, and military technology. The acidic runoff from these mines is strong enough to dissolve metals from surrounding soil at very high concentrations. Today, these environmental catastrophes, long characterized as waste, are being recharacterized as valuable domestic orebodies, and sites at the frontier of American technical infrastructure.

These stores of industrial pollution are the subject of a widespread mapping and profiling effort by the US Geological Survey's (USGS) Earth Mapping Resources Initiative (Earth MRI) in its search for "unconventional sources of valuable minerals." The initiative emerges from US anxiety over supply chains strained by fracturing global capitalism and rising conflict, which threaten the infrastructure AI data centers depend on. With only one domestic source of rare earth elements, the US Department of Defense (DOD) is funding demonstration projects across the nation's interior that experiment with ways to refine and harvest these second-order residues, from chemical leaching to bioaccumulation and nanoscale filtration.

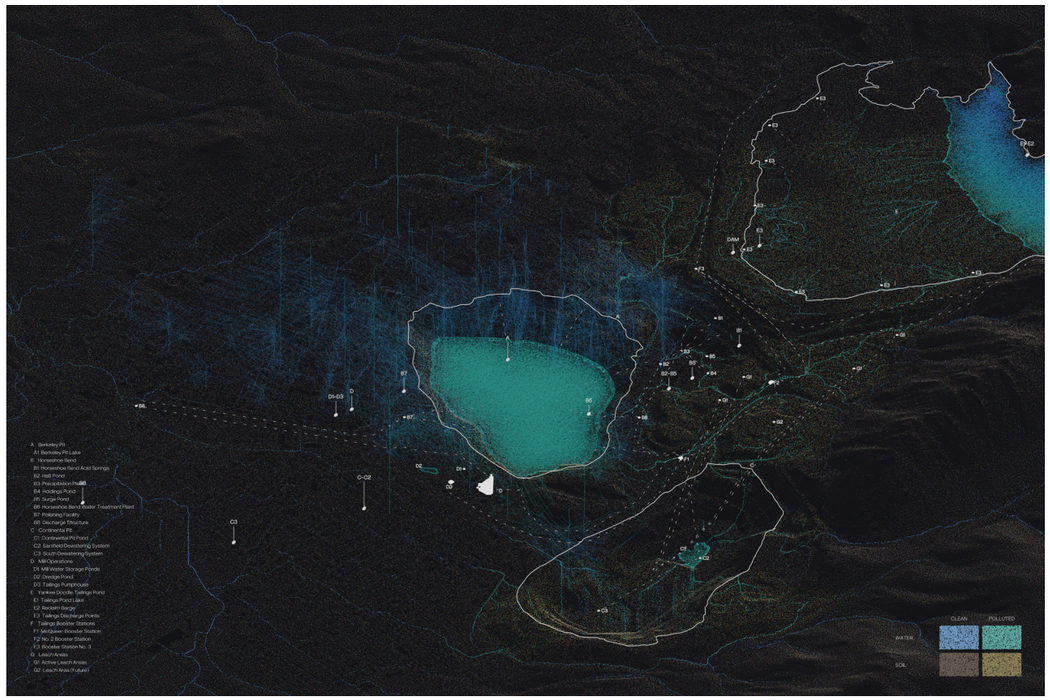
Tailings grounds itself in the material processes and metabolic flows of Butte, Montana—a storied labor town, and one such demonstration site identified by the USGS and DOD. Once the epicenter of global copper production, Butte is now home to the Berkeley Pit: a polluted, highly acidic lake, and popular example of environmental catastrophe at the hands of industrial capitalism. As virtual space accelerates from massive speculative investments in technical infrastructure, nodes of this buildout surface with unusual clarity in Butte: century-old mine tailings are re-mined for rare earth elements, a 400-MW data center is built along Silver Bow Creek, and Butte's long history of organized labor attempts to orient itself to a new wave of corporate power, environmental recklessness, and automation.

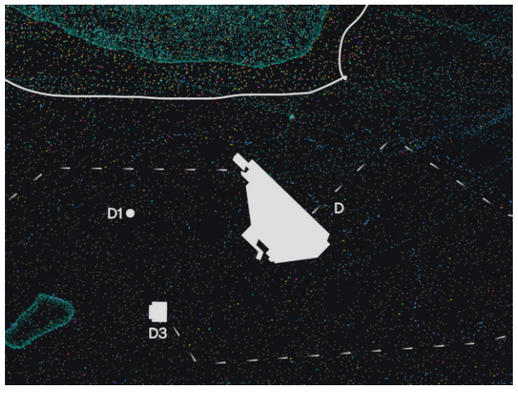
Credits and Collaborators

Individual project, with assistance from:
Rosalea Monacella (Design Critic in LA, Harvard GSD)
Tobias Putrih (Lecturer, MIT)
Gediminas Urbonas (Associate Professor, MIT)
Rami Dana (Research Scientist, Materials & Engineering, MIT)

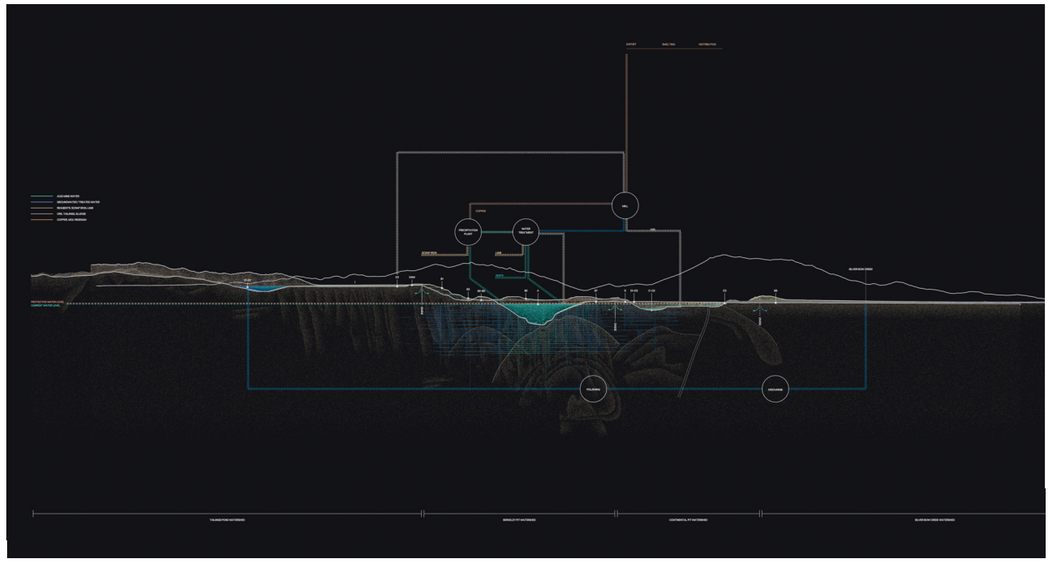


Plan view of Butte, Montana
The Berkeley Pit lake (A) and the Yankee Doodle Tailings Pond (E) are joined by the corridor of pipelines, treatment plants and pumping stations between them. Teal marks acid mine water pooling in the pit; blue marks surface water and groundwater moving through the valley. The lettered key identifies each facility.





[top right] Axonometric view of the Berkeley Pit and the Yankee Doodle Tailings Pond



[middle left] unfolding of section line unfolding from plan

[middle right] Detail of Mill operations.

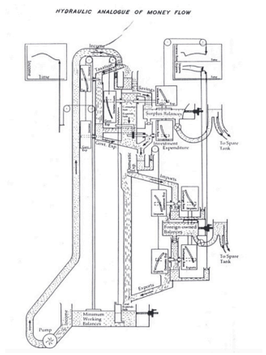
[Bottom] Section through Butte: old and new metabolics

Butte, Montana and sites like it across the nation's interior, are the material start/endpoint supplying state and corporate speculation on the shape and material resource demands of a new economy emerging from old: a bet on the mass automation of software and information economy. A bet on capital over human labor. These investments measure in the hundreds of billions of dollars, and flow through a new set of corporate monopolies. Each holding a share in the other, each projecting an economy who's self-referentiality is increasingly blatant. To the degree these trends are bounded by the state, it is as investor rather than regulator.

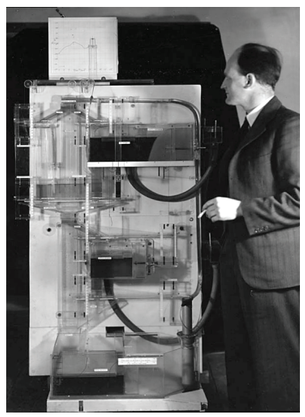
If the MONIAC (Figure 1, 2) imagined the economy as water moving through tanks, this new economy is a version of that machine warped beyond its own legibility. In Tailings, the tank extends a version of this mirrored hydrologic metaphor: a fantastical dual image for the governance of economy and environmental flow.

As the models that produce our digital infrastructure begin to consume this second-order material, the model of extraction folds inward, further entering its own synthetic space. Through staged circulatory sculptures and nanoscale imaging of polluted wastewater, *Tailings* explores the logics of industrial capitalism, the mechanical gaze turning inward, loops, false loops, and the component parts of a metabolic model churning.

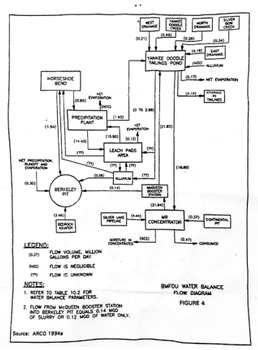
The project centers a series of arched tanks. These Accumulators operate as various "metabolic quotations" of the Butte landscape and citations of the economic models directing its governance and use. The project takes self-referentiality—a folding inward—as both a guiding prompt for artistic research and aesthetic cue.



[Figure 1] The Phillips Economic Analog Computer, dubbed the MONIAC: Monetary National Income Analogue Computer, as a reference to ENIAC, early digital computer that ran the first computerized weather forecast a year earlier.

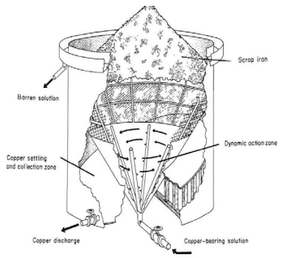


[Figure 2] Inventor and economist Bill Phillips, demonstrates in a physical way the circular flow of money within the economy.

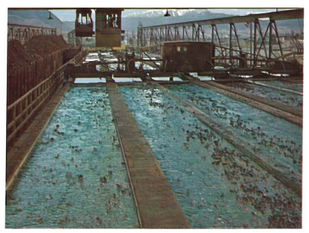


[Figure 3] U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, "Amendment to National Oil and Hazardous Substance Contingency Plan; National Priorities List," Federal Register 48, no. 175 (September 8, 1983): 40658–73.

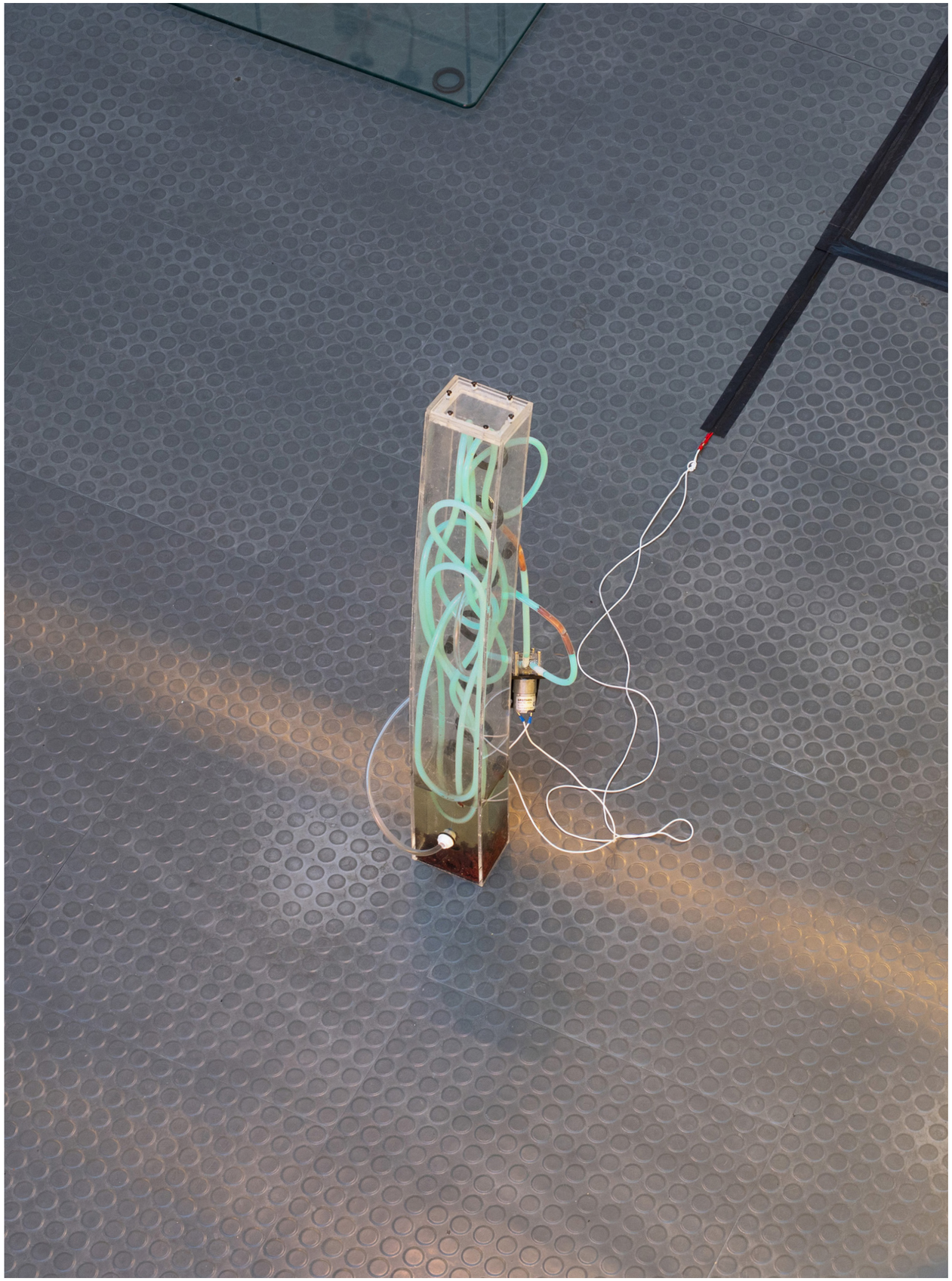
[Figure 4] Berkeley Pit in Butte Montana. Berkeley Pit, Butte, Montana, c. 1979–80. Historic American Engineering Record, HAER MT-36-D-3. Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division



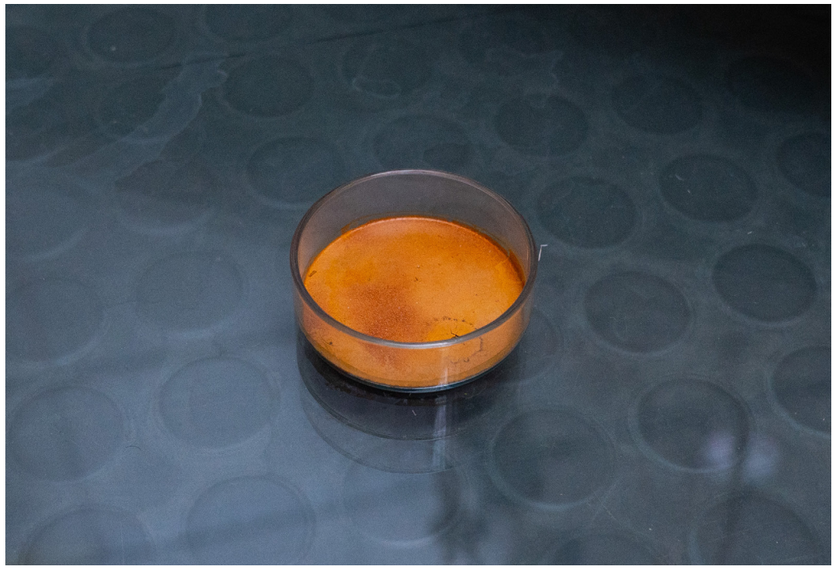
[Figure 5] Cutaway Diagram of Cone Precipitator for the reclamation of copper from Kennecott Copper Corp.



[Figure 6] The Horseshoe Bend Water Treatment Facility in Butte, Montana is operated by the Montana Resources. The facility pumps copper-rich lake water from the Berkeley Pit onto large baths containing bits of scrap iron and steel. Through the process of cementation, the dissolved copper is released as solid nodules that are then collected for smelting and sale.



Accumulator 01
copper joints, electrolyte, iron, peristaltic pump, acrylic, silicone, precipitated copper
2025



[Figure 7] Petridish sample of cement copper from of *Accumulator 01*.

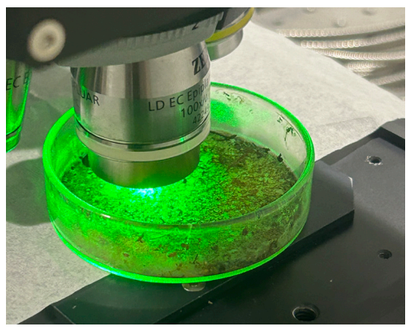
[Figure 8] Top: Lower bath of *Accumulator 01* with cemented copper produced from the tank's circuitry.

This artistic research, spanning networked tanks, generative video, technical imaging, painting, and primary-source archival documents, frames a landscape produced by economic, political, and social forces over time. Its contours record an accumulation of sediment formed from the gaps between model and ground. In Butte, that ground is shifting again, reorganized again by speculative bets on capital over labor.

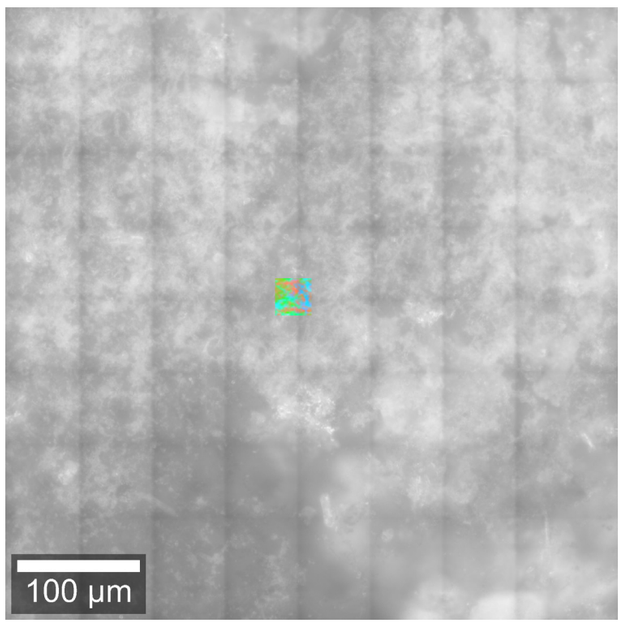
The sediments I produce in my metabolic models of these landscapes also serve as a material and conceptual hinge elsewhere in my practice: in the studio, these sediments are rerouted away from industrial prduction and toward cultural production.

Specifically, in some type of personal refusal, I collect the copper sediments that form in Accumulator 01, grind them into pigment, and bind them into watercolor with honey and gum arabic. These rough paints join verdigris and other pigments made in the studio, and are used in a series of paintings (see Model 12 – untitled, and others in section *Plots, Grids, Models*)

The paintings become a kind of metabolic image.



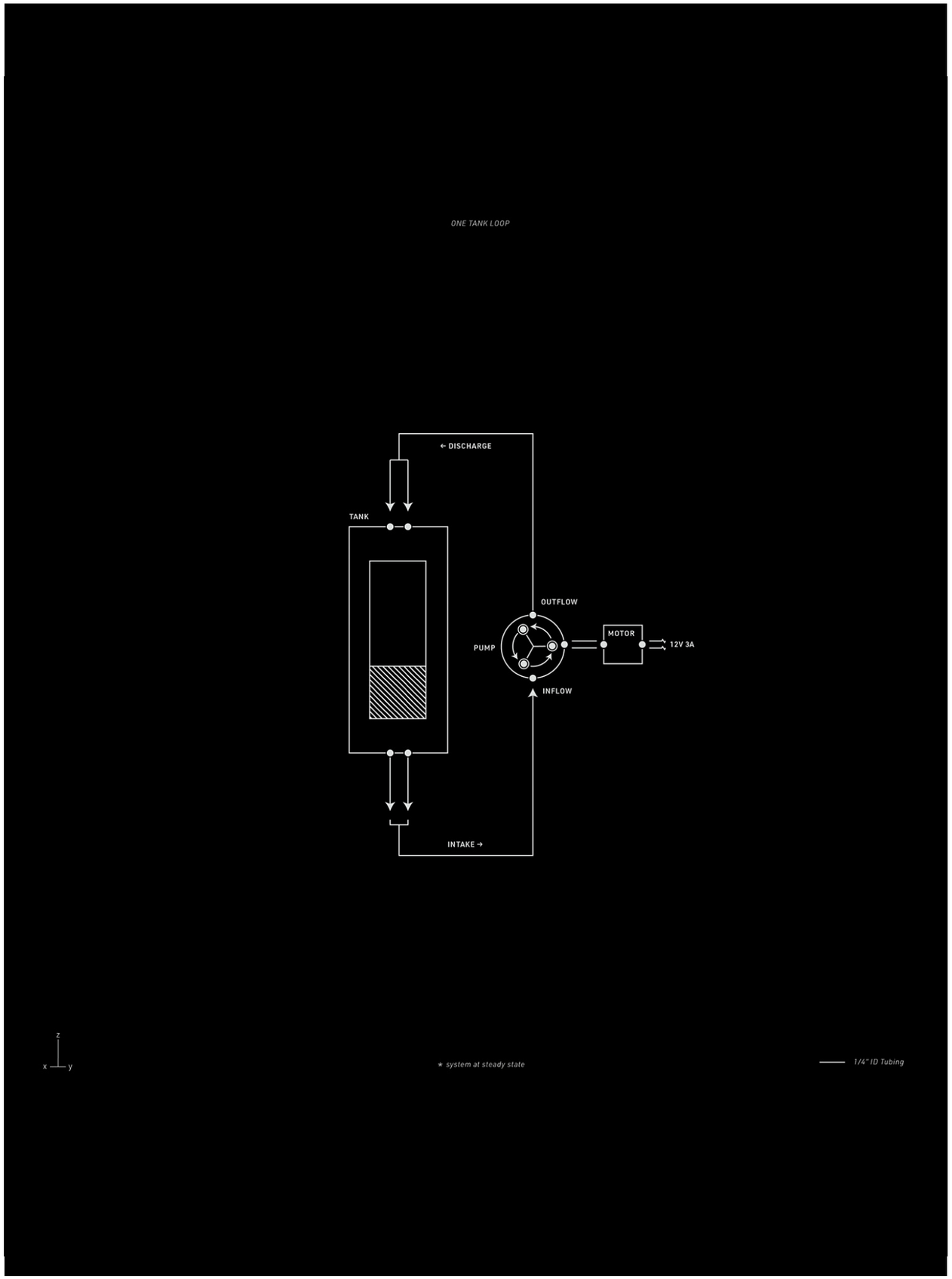
[Figure 9] RAMAN spectrograph of wastewater samle from Superfund Site in Woburn MA taken by the artist. This method of imaging maps the various chemical compositions of sample material. RAMAN spectroscopy is used in a variety of fields, from the characterization of paint in art conservation, to the search heavy metals in environmental samples.



[Figure 10] Gradient map of materials in industrial wastewater sample. Composite image was captured and configured by confocal Raman imaging system alpha300 from Witec.

[Figure 11] Live embedding representations of an autoencoder machine learning model training on archival image dataset of Butte, Montana.

Model 12 (untitled)
11 x 17 inches
copper and cobalt derived pigments on watercolor on paper, mounted on wood panel
2025



Accumulator base component, flow diagram
Programmable tank unit with diaphragm pump, valves, and air compressor; scalable base unit for the series
2026

Accumulators

Artistic Research
Architecture

2025-26

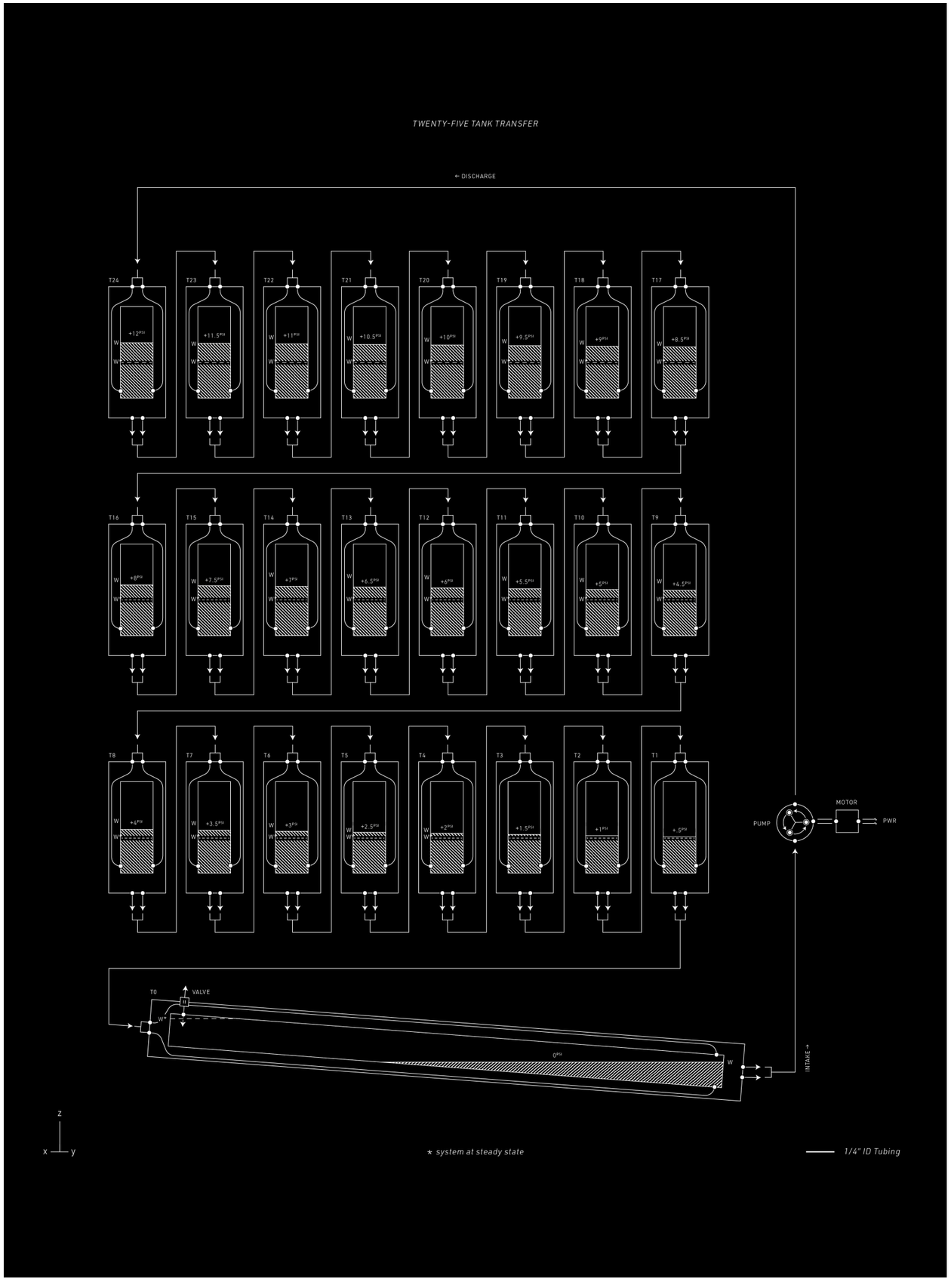
Each instance of the *Accumulators* begin from a single base component, an arched tank with interchangable end-caps that allow inputs and outputs through various pumps, tubes, and fittings. Multiple units can be assembled into larger devices to contain and pass media. The series serves as a set of conceptual devices for thinking about themes of scalability, containment, and feedback in landscape.

Each iteration of this work is intantiated as a kind of performance.

Credits and Collaborators

Individual project.
Funding and support from Harvard GSD Design Research Grant and the Massachussets Cultural Council

Accumulator 03
acrylic, steel, silicone, diaphragm pump, benton-
ite drilling clay, air compressor
2026


TWENTY-FIVE TANK TRANSFER
← DISCHARGE
T24
+12PSI
T23
+11.5PSI
T22
+11PSI
T21
+10.5PSI
T20
+10PSI
T19
+9.5PSI
T18
+9PSI
T17
+8.5PSI
T16
+8PSI
T15
+7.5PSI
T14
+7PSI
T13
+6.5PSI
T12
+6PSI
T11
+5.5PSI
T10
+5PSI
T9
+4.5PSI
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T1
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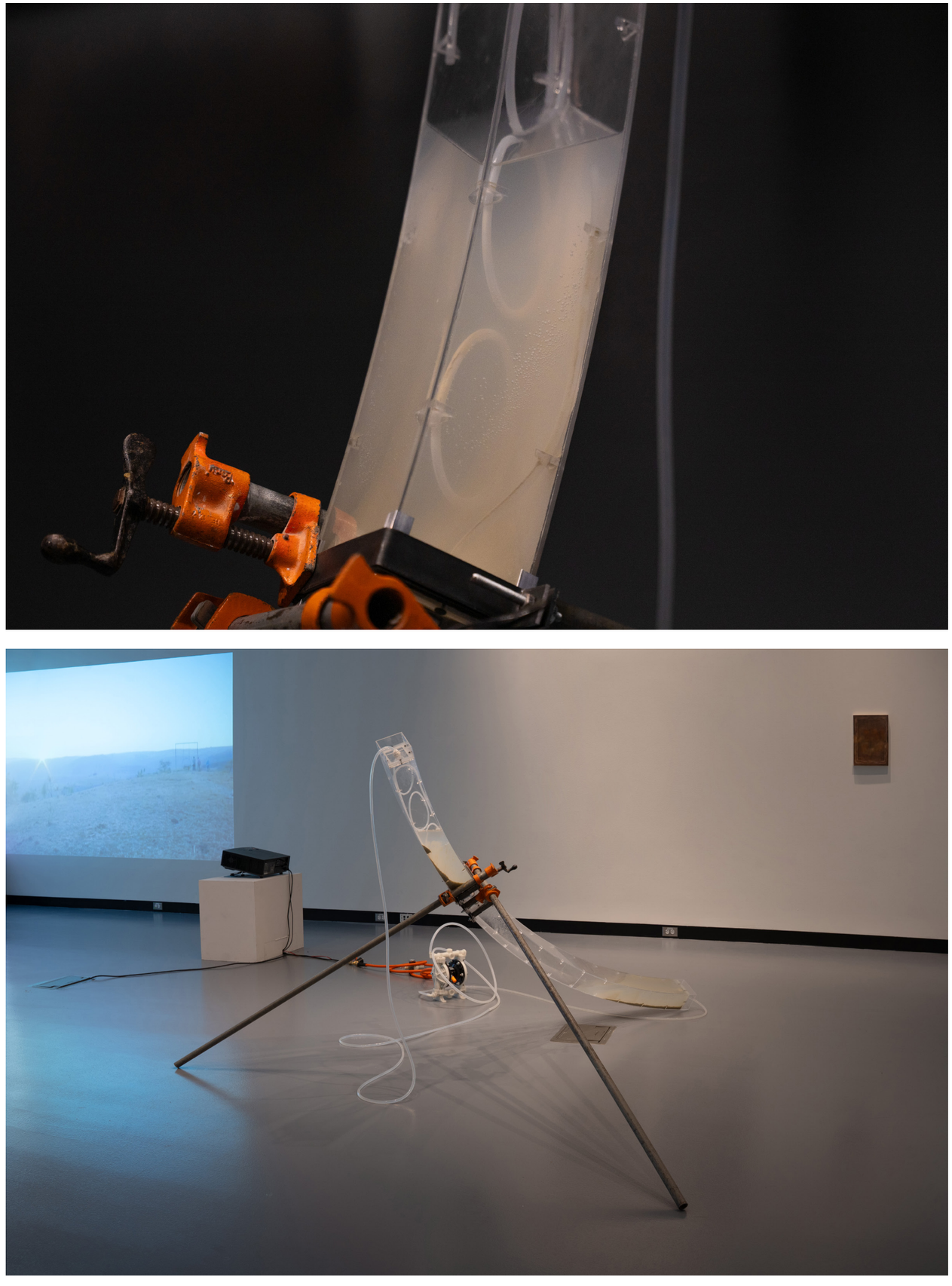
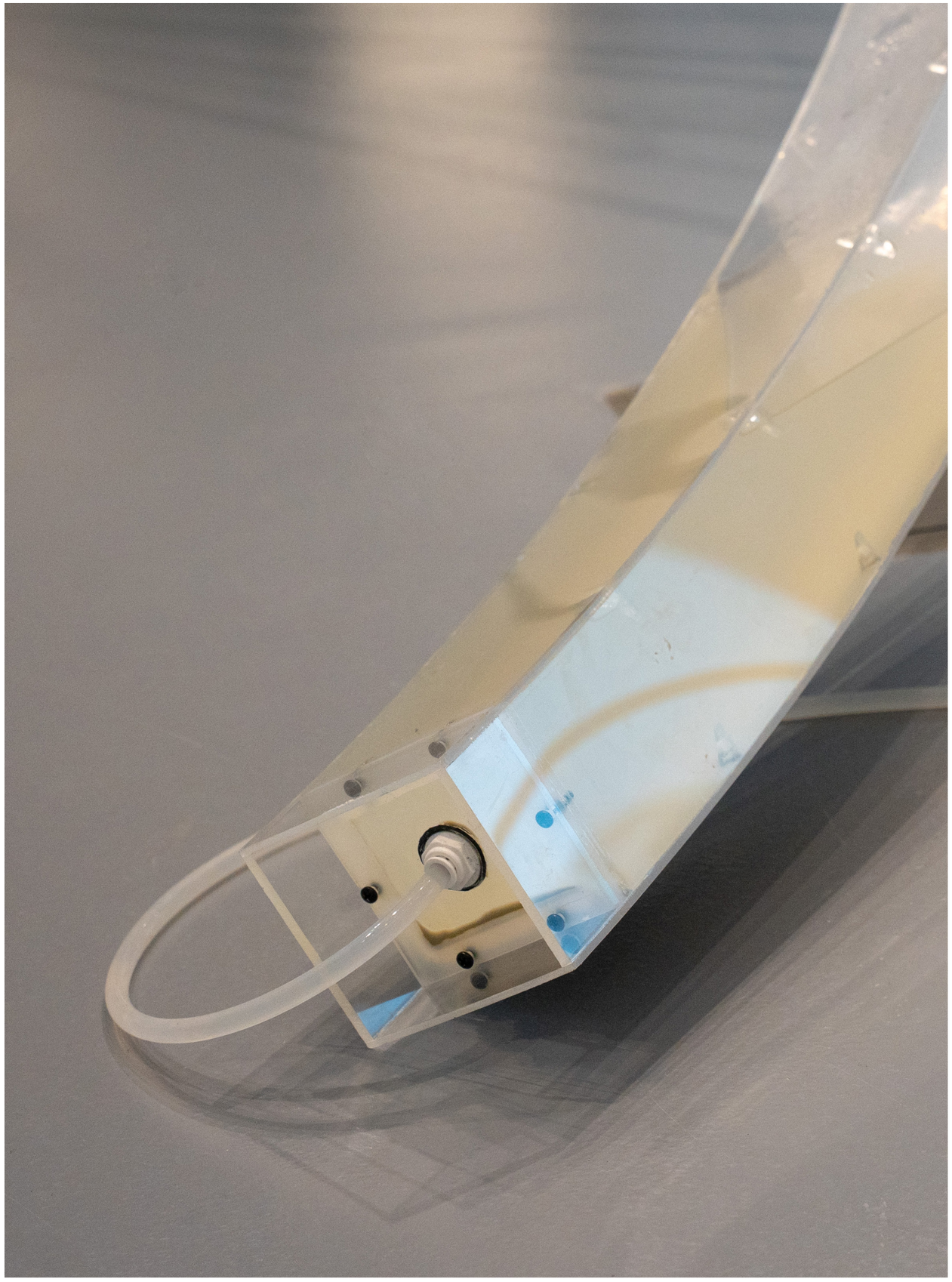
INTAKE +
z
x
y
* system at steady state
1/4" ID Tubing





Accumulator 03 (detail)
acrylic, steel, silicone, diaphragm pump, benton-
ite drilling clay, air compressor
2026

Accumulator 03 (detail)
acrylic, steel, silicone, diaphragm pump, benton-
ite drilling clay, air compressor
2026

Eric Rannestad, On Weather Forecasting: Infrastructure, Models, and Material Registration. (147 pages). Harvard Graduate School of Design. 2026

On Weather Forecasting
Infrastructure, Models, and Material Registration

Design Research

2026

Through the coupled forms of the book and the art object, this Open Project engages recent shifts in weather forecasting: its infrastructure, models, and material registration—as a contested apparatus that both observes and produces conditions of crisis across economic, social, cultural, and ecological domains from which it emerged.

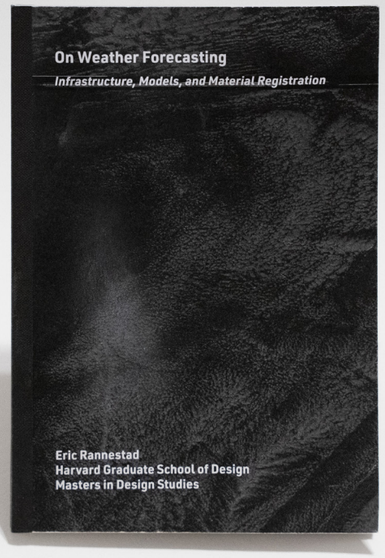
The project describes the formation of the public weather forecast and its capture by private interests. Private capital's entrenchment in the forecasting space is driven by recent technical shifts in weather modeling that favor compute-heavy AI-methods over physics-based models, as well as a long-running effort to defund aspects of the public forecasting stack through a history of rent seeking behavior. What emerges is a privatized forecast that further produces a kind of temporal asymmetry, exploitable across short and long time horizons: in energy markets, the high-frequency trading of weather-exposed assets, regional insurance markets, and other forms of climate redlining.

This version of the forecast further entrenches financialized understandings of time as the model for managing risk in an uncertain world. As the private forecasting stack emerges, anxieties around future landscapes are more active than ever in proposals for digital twins, large scale atmospheric interventions, and other infrastructures of environmental control.

The structure of the project references the form of the almanac as a situated mode of speculation which explores how models are coproductive with the world and posits that other models of relating to uncertainty are both possible and necessary.

Credits and Collaborators

Individual project.
Advised by Rosalea Monacella (Design Critic in LA, Harvard GSD) as part of *Open Project: Energy Dreams* at the Harvard Graduate School of Design.



When this position of the future is projected onto Esposito's financial economy of observers observing the observer, all with the interest of buying future certainty, we develop a relational panopticon of flocking agents, orienting themselves in self-conscious and increasingly abstract relations to each other. The ordering logic of these conic agents is nonsensical and oriented toward the goal of predicting the movement of the other.

In the sense that these agents self-organize, they do so according to their internal rules of capital accumulation, given that money fundementally defers decision making about the future, and because the future is fundamentally uncertain, one can never accumulate enough. So, as a flock, these agents lift, [3] or in the case of financial crisis after crisis, one agent follows another, follows another, into the ground.

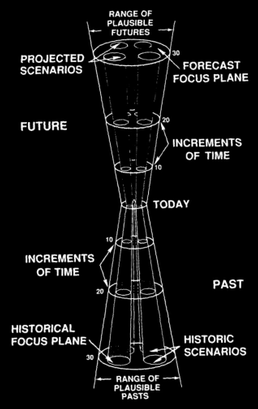
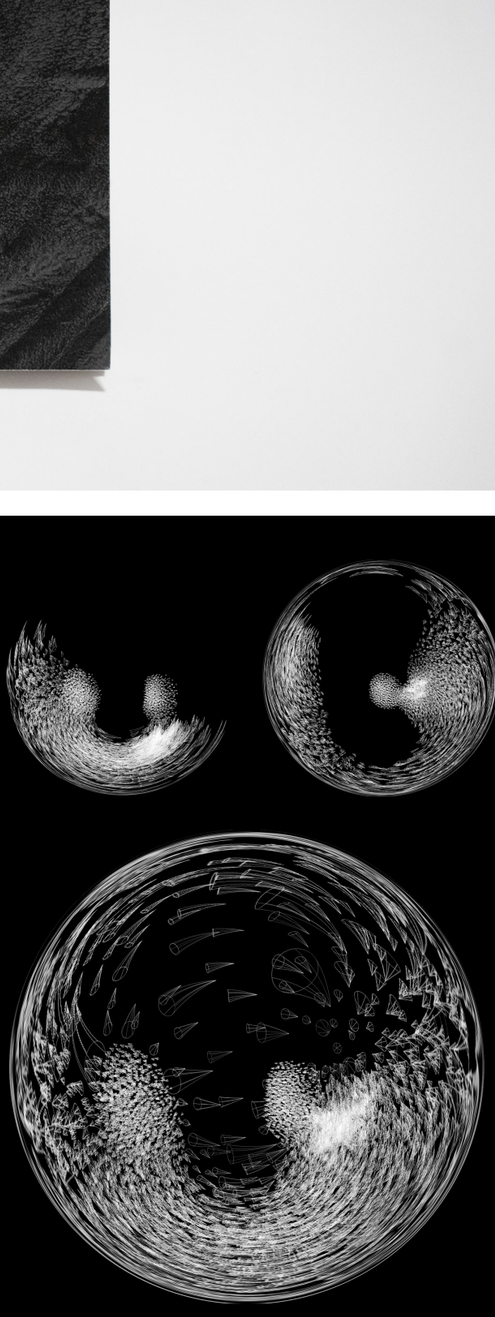
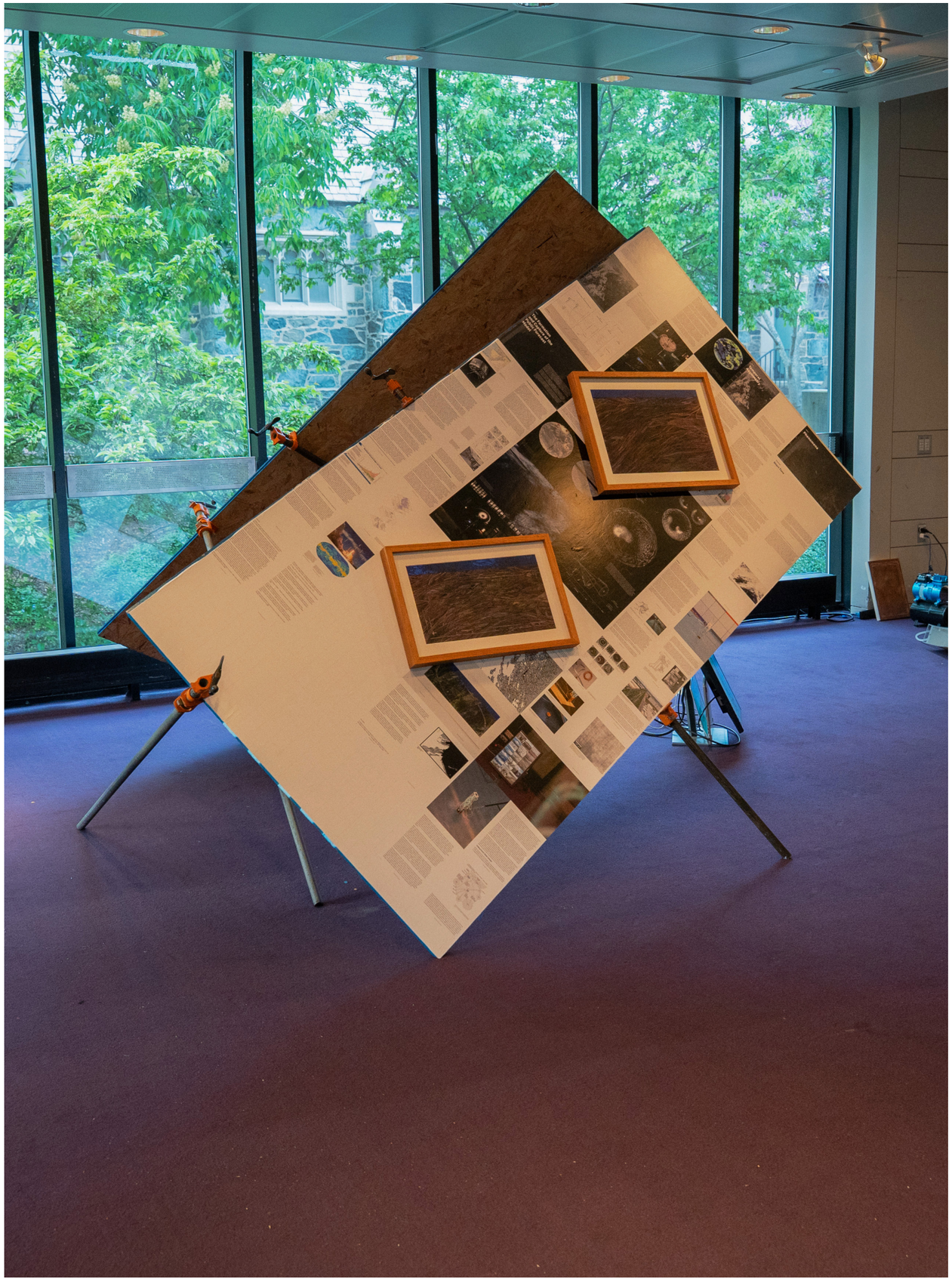


Figure 1. The Cone of Possibilities by C. W. Taylor, 1990. Taylor developed the "Cone of Plausibility" while at the U.S. Army War College

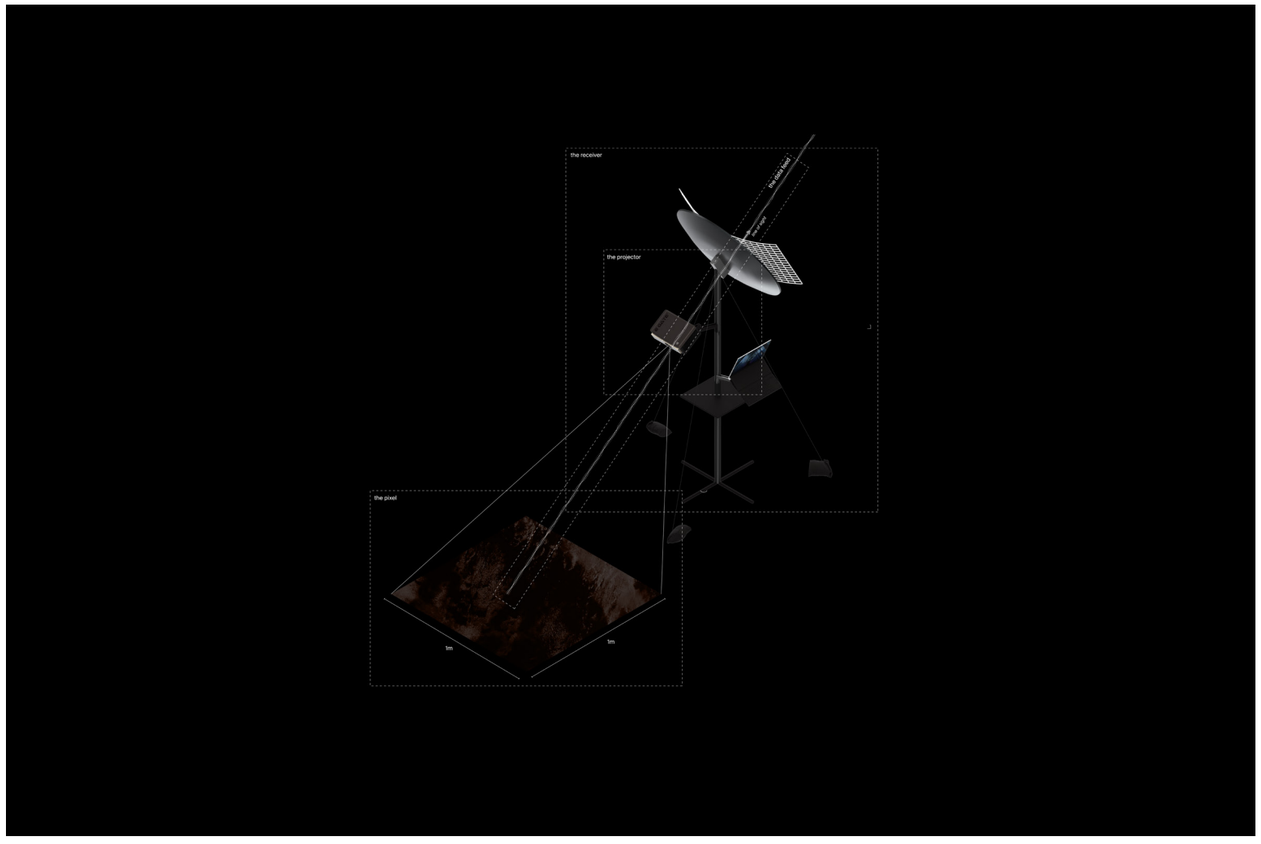


Composite of multiple select spreads from the book: On Weather Forecasting: Infrastructure, Models, and Material Registration. (147 pages). Harvard Graduate School of Design. 2026



Installation View...

Pixel Earth, installation view
Satellite receiving antenna, software-defined radio, projector, live GOES-East imagery
2024



Pixel Earth, system diagram
Signal path from geostationary satellite to antenna, receiver, and 1:1 ground projection
2024

Pixel Earth

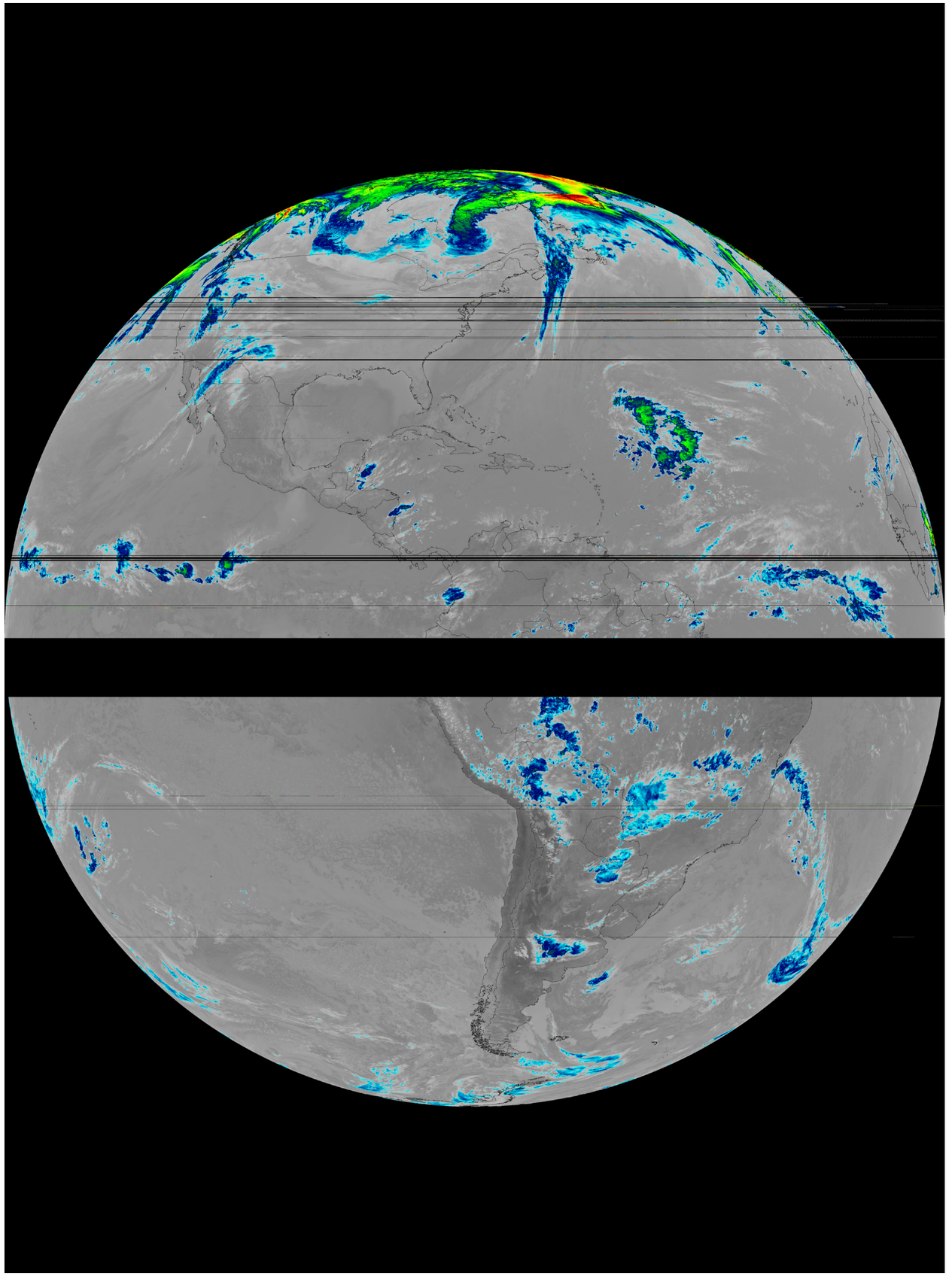
Design Research
Artistic Research

2024

This installation establishes a live connection to a geostationary weather satellite, receiving real-time imagery of Earth. From a high-resolution image, a single pixel is isolated and projected onto its corresponding one square meter of ground, creating a 1:1 alignment between satellite data and physical space. By scaling planetary imagery to the dimensions it represents, the work materializes the basic unit of remote sensing and exposes how global perception is constructed through discrete measurements.

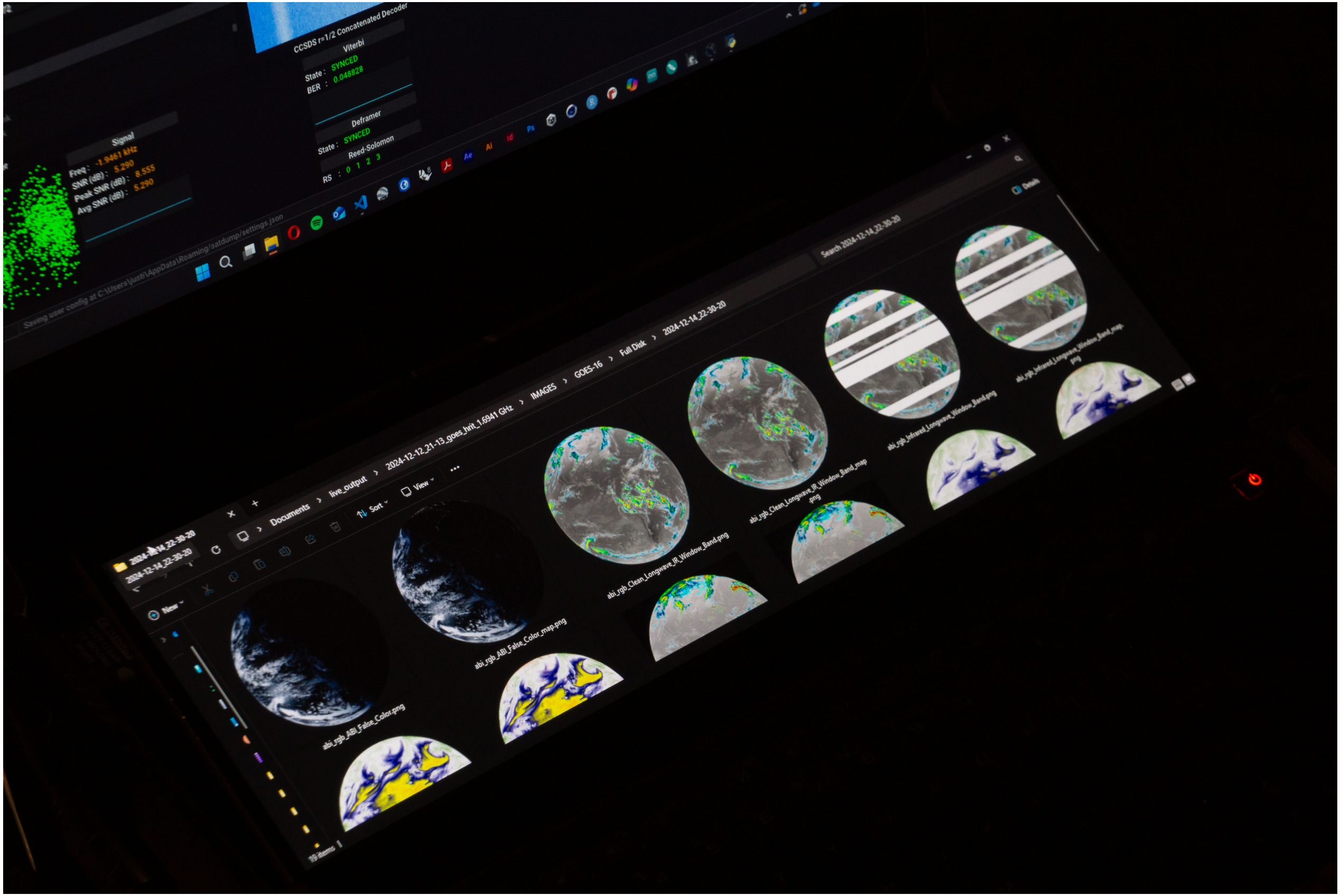
Credits and Collaborators

Collaboration with Justin Booz for the *Mediums Proseminar* course at the Harvard Graduate School of Design.

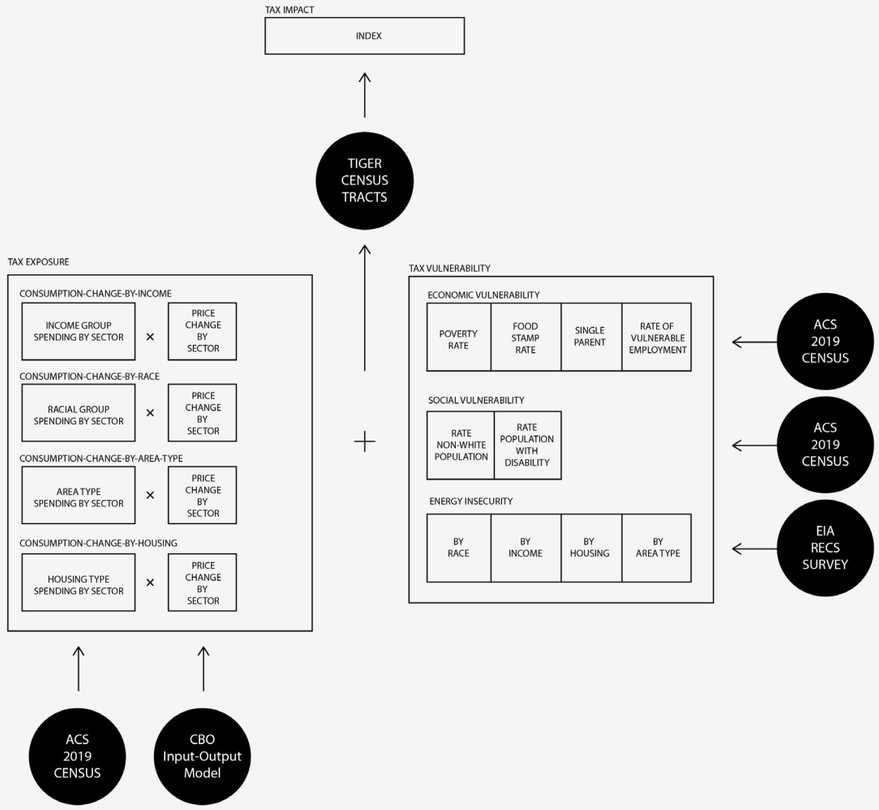


[Left] Colorized rendering of ABI Band 7, the Shortwave Window Band of GOES East. Recieved in the 2024-12-12_17-30-20 data packet by Pixel Earth installation. The 3.9 µm "Shortwave Window" Band at 2 km resolution. It has a variety of applications including fire detection, cloud particle size retrievals, and differentiating between liquid water and ice clouds. Recieved in the 2024-12-12_17-30-20 data packet by Pixel Earth.

[Right] Pixel Earth, GOES-East full-disk image received on site; receiving antenna, installation view
2024



Pixel Earth, live processing interface and sequence of received images from GOES East in December 2024.



A carbon price will eventually reach consumers, either directly through higher prices for carbon-intensive goods or indirectly through lost wages and capital. An Input-Output model such as IMPLAN could measure these price changes, but because the project has limited resources, this analysis uses an existing Congressional Budget Office study that models how a carbon tax changes prices across consumption sectors. Those price changes are applied to Consumer Expenditure Survey data, which breaks spending down by demographic group, to estimate how the tax would affect each group's spending. Each census tract is then weighted by the pre- and post-tax spending of its demographic makeup, giving an index of the tract's economic exposure. Finally, that exposure index is combined with variables that approximate a population's vulnerability to economic shocks to produce an overall Tax Impact (I) index.

Distributional Impact of a Carbon Tax on Washington State Consumers

Economic Modeling
Spatial Analysis
Cartography

2021

The project models the uneven economic burden a carbon tax would have on Washington households. To spatialize how effects will impact different communities across the state, the project maps changes in hypothetical spending patterns .

Enacting a carbon tax is particularly contentious, not because of disagreements on the method of peguvian taxation, but largely due to disagreements on how to best spend the revenue generated by such a tax. A primary point of contention within this debate is how to remediate the tax's impact on vulnerable populations.

While all contextual components of enacting a carbon tax are important, this analysis intends to identify only the distributional effects of a carbon tax policy on the consumer. This single contextual contribution is capable of helping to inform questions around equity and how revenues might be spent to bolster populations vulnerable to a carbon price. The location of infrastructure projects or renewable energy projects linked to this revenue are examples of on-the-ground spending that should be informed by this analysis.

Credits and Collaborators

Individual project for professional certificate in GIS + Design from the Pratt Institute.

Distributional Impact of a Carbon Tax on Washington Consumers

Background

Enacting a carbon tax in Washington State is a losing game. In the past six years, advocates of carbon pricing have tried and failed, twice, to pass some form of carbon pricing.

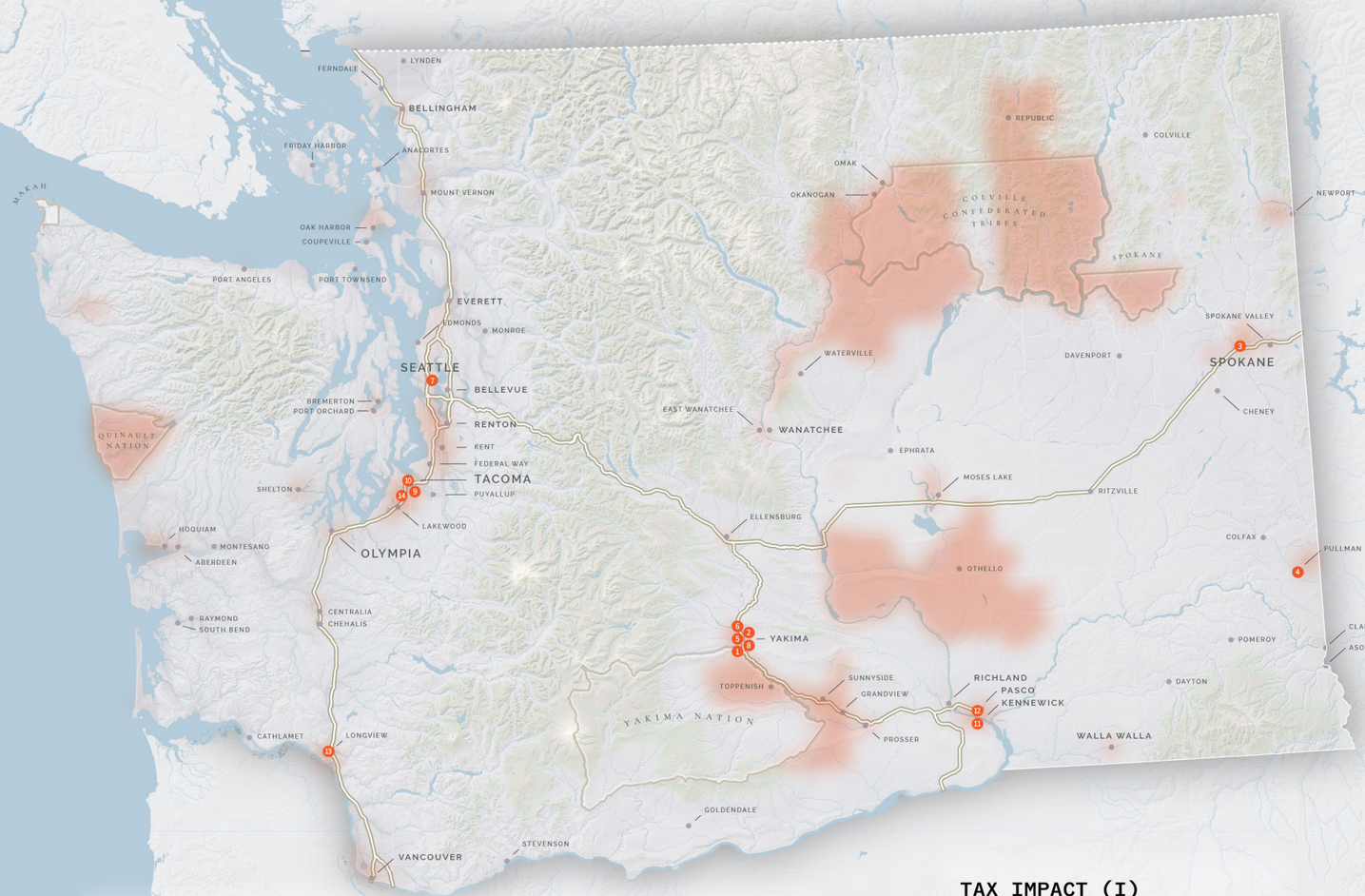
I-732 was the first to be rejected. The ballot initiative proposed a carbon neutral (and aggressive) tax that credited revenues back to low-income households and cut the states sales tax by 1%. The second ballot-initiative, I-1631, functioned as much as a revenue source as it did a price signal. The initiative proposed investing potential revenues in equity-forward green-energy and infrastructure projects — something that I-732 avoided entirely.

Proponents of each strategy have since debated the right mix of climate policy that is equitably distributed, capable of reducing state emissions, and able to attain political viability. In climate policy circles, there is consensus that the taxation side of a carbon tax (ignoring revenue investment) is an effective way to curb emissions. However, there is a great deal of disagreement over how best to spend the tax's revenue.

There a several schools of thought, but the primary divergent perspectives are:

- Invest tax revenue in a way that promotes renewable energy growth and in projects that mitigate the effects of climate change.
- Invest tax revenue in a way that benefits those who are most effected by the tax. This could be done by offering a strategically laced dividend, rebate, or tax cut.

Each method comes with distinct challenges and benefits. The first method is geared more toward a progressive implementation and can potentially have the most impact on transitioning to a low carbon future. Tax the bad, invest in the good. The latter spending method still holds progressive potential, but compromises slightly in favor of popular and political appeal.



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3	SPOKANE, SPOKANE COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53063003500	IMPACT 5.85	
4	PULLMAN, WHITMAN COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53075000100	IMPACT 5.77	
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6	YAKIMA, YAKIMA COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53077000200	IMPACT 5.47	
7	SEATTLE, KING COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53033005302	IMPACT 5.39	
8	YAKIMA, YAKIMA COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53077001502	IMPACT 5.38	
9	TACOMA, PIERCE COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53053940006	IMPACT 5.37	
10	TACOMA, PIERCE COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53053061400	IMPACT 5.37	
11	TRI CITIES, BENTON COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53005011200	IMPACT 5.17	
12	TRI CITIES, FRANKLIN COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53021020200	IMPACT 5.07	
13	VANCOUVER, COWLITZ COUNTY, CENSUS TRACT: 53015001000	IMPACT 5.05	
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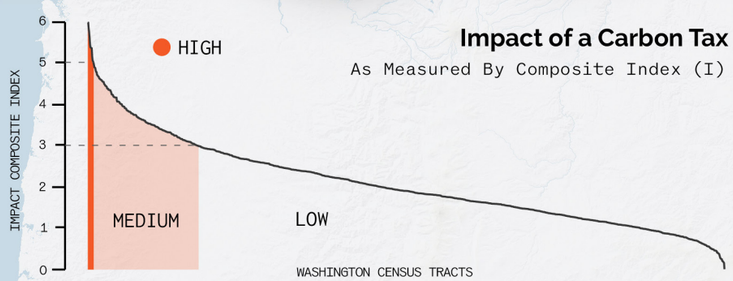


Impact of a Carbon Tax
As Measured By Composite Index (I)

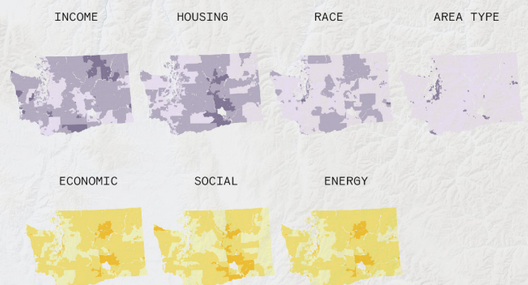
TAX IMPACT (I)

TAX EXPOSURE (E)

- CONSUMPTION CHANGE BY INCOME
- CONSUMPTION CHANGE BY RACE
- CONSUMPTION CHANGE BY AREA TYPE
- CONSUMPTION CHANGE BY HOUSING

POPULATION VULNERABILITY (V)

- ECONOMIC VULNERABILITY
- SOCIAL VULNERABILITY
- ENERGY VULNERABILITY



Project Significance

It is very difficult for either method to spend tax revenue in an effective way unless there is a deep understanding of a) how polluters will react to a price on carbon and b) the distributional effects of climate change, pollution, and the carbon tax itself.

While all contextual components of enacting such a policy are important, this analysis intends to identify only the distributional effects of a carbon tax policy on the consumer. This single contextual component is capable of informing questions around equity and how revenues can be spent to bolster populations vulnerable to a carbon price. Knowing, the spatial distribution of such a tax and which vulnerable populations are most impacted can inform strategies for revenue spending. Each spending method targets these inequities — just in different ways.

Methodology

A price on carbon will eventually be passed to the consumer — either as explicitly higher prices for carbon related goods, or as lost wages/capital that will lead to relatively higher prices for carbon related goods.

Measuring these relative price changes can be done via an Input-Output (IO) model such as IMPLAN. However, due to limited resources for the project, this analysis uses an existing study of relative price changes to consumption sectors instead.

This price change data is then combined with Consumer Expenditure Survey (CES) consumption data across various demographic categories. The CES lists spending by demographic characteristics. To gauge how this spending would be impacted by a carbon tax, these consumption statistics are modified by the findings of the above study.

To visualize the spatial distribution of impacted populations across the state, this project weights census tract population data with the modified price change information based on that tract's demographic makeup. The result is an index value that approximates the economic exposure to a carbon tax.

The last piece of this linear model, is a set of variables that approximates a population's vulnerability to economic shocks. These values, and the above economic exposure index value, are then combined to create an general Tax Impact (I) index value.

Data Sources

Tax Analysis Division, & Perese, K., INPUT-OUTPUT MODEL ANALYSIS: PRICING CARBON DIOXIDE EMISSIONS (2010). Working Paper Series. Retrieved from https://www.cbo.gov-/sites/default/files/111th-congress-2009-2010/workingpaper/2010-04-io_model_paper_0.pdf.

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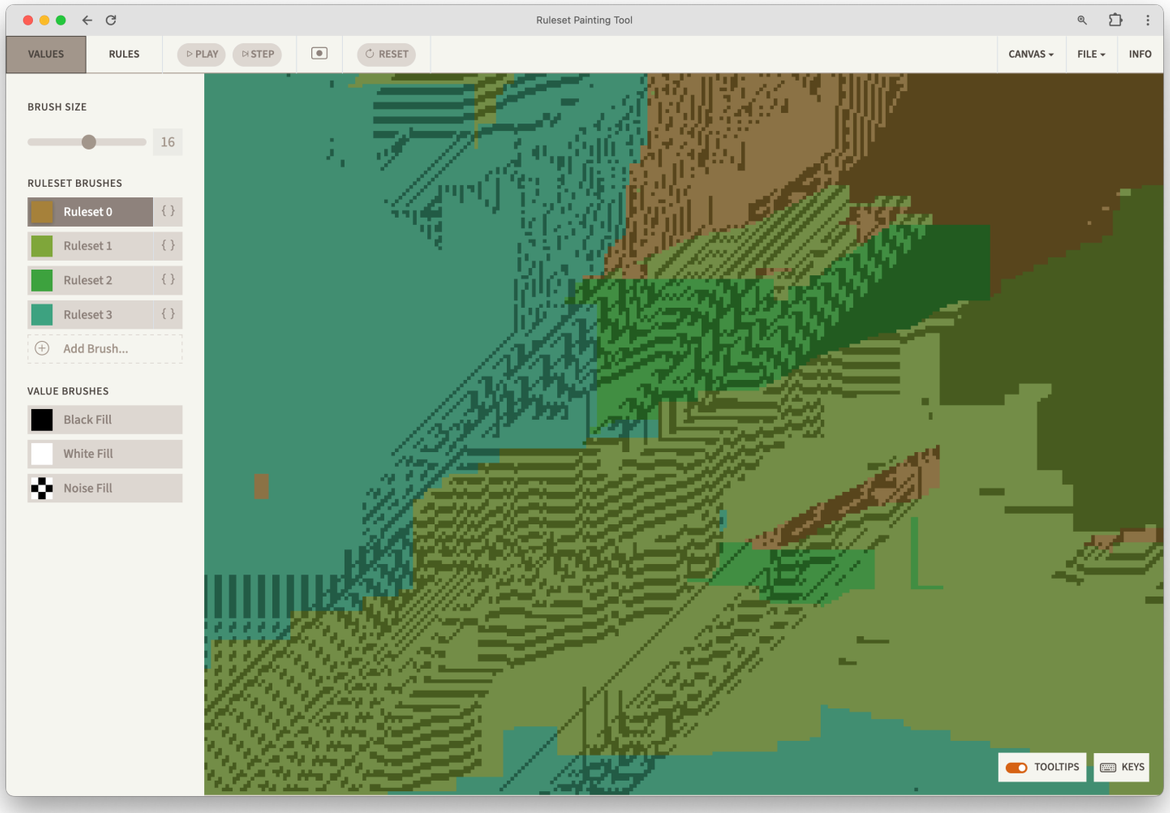
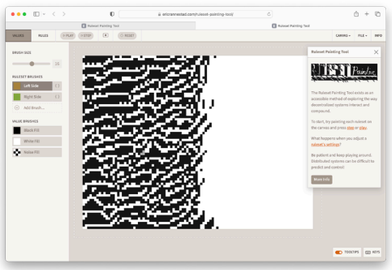
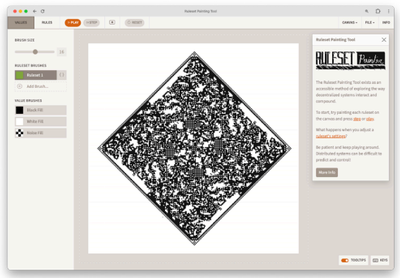
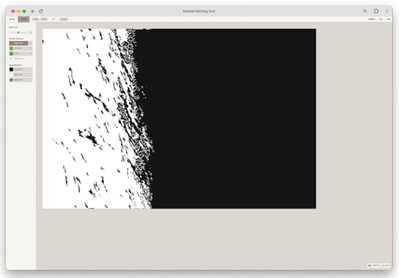








Ruleset Painting Tool
Tool for Designing Adjacent Cell-Based Emergent Systems

Computational Design

2023

The Ruleset Painting Tool is an interactive web application that allows users to visualize and explore how distributed systems interact, compound, and evolve through time.

While traditional simulation tools apply a single, uniform mathematical rule across a canvas, this interface allows users to physically paint, arrange, and nest entirely different cellular automata systems adjacent to one another within a single composition. The interface provides users a framework for conceptualizing computation, natural structures, and complex environmental systems as collections of individual entities operating under decentralized, localized logic. Much like a single bird dictating the emergent shape of a flock, or localized ecological patches defining the dynamics of a broader landscape, these individual components collectively generate highly complex, unforeseen structures. By providing a real-time sandbox for drawing, coding, and playing with these behaviors directly in the browser, the tool translates the abstract physics of complexity theory into a tactile, visual medium.

The tool offers a number of import and export options. In my personal art practice, it served as the foundational canvas for layers underlying *Ruleset Paintings - Models 1–3*.

Credits and Collaborators

Individual Project.
Hand-coded without assistance from AI coding tools.

Firmament Truss
OSB panel, plywood, Aqua-Resin, fiberglass, steel, aeroponic growing system, [dimensions]
2023

Firmaments

Art
Architecture

2021-23

Many pre-scientific cosmologies understand the sky as a common architectural structure: a firmament, or a large glass dome that separates earth from the oceans of heaven. *Firmaments* take interest with such topologic models of the earth and the systems of environmental control they associate with.

These borrow their form from such models of atmosphere and conflate these models with aestheticized utopian fragments from the imagination of green capital. These fantastical installations house a system of tanks, tubes, pumps, and nozzles that create an aeroponic growing environment. Here, domesticated plants grow in irregular and confined spaces with minimal water waste or reliance on natural light.

Credits and Collaborators

Individual project.
Funding and support from Clowes Fund Fellowship, Vermont Studio Center and the Emerson Center for Arts and Culture in Bozeman, Montana

Firmament Truss
OSB panel, plywood, Aqua-Resin, fiberglass, steel, aeroponic growing system, [dimensions]
2023

Architectural detail of STRATA installation view, Harvard Yard. 2025

STRATA

Social Architecture

2025

As part of the 2025 Harvard Arts Festival, this installation references the recent archeologic excavations near the location of the 17th century Harvard Indian College. The soil and other material deposits beneath the site evidence a continuum of interconnected processes that began as a settler-colonial project, unfolding across time and space into our present moment—transformed, but embedded.

Designed in partnership with the Harvard University Native American Program (HUNAP), this geotextile structure references a theoretical volume of extracted earth, and presents it above ground as a critical activation of public space. The installation's associated program of events, films, and discussions engaged the indigenous history of the site, mythologies of Harvard's origin, and the myth (un)making functions of archeology.

Credits and Collaborators

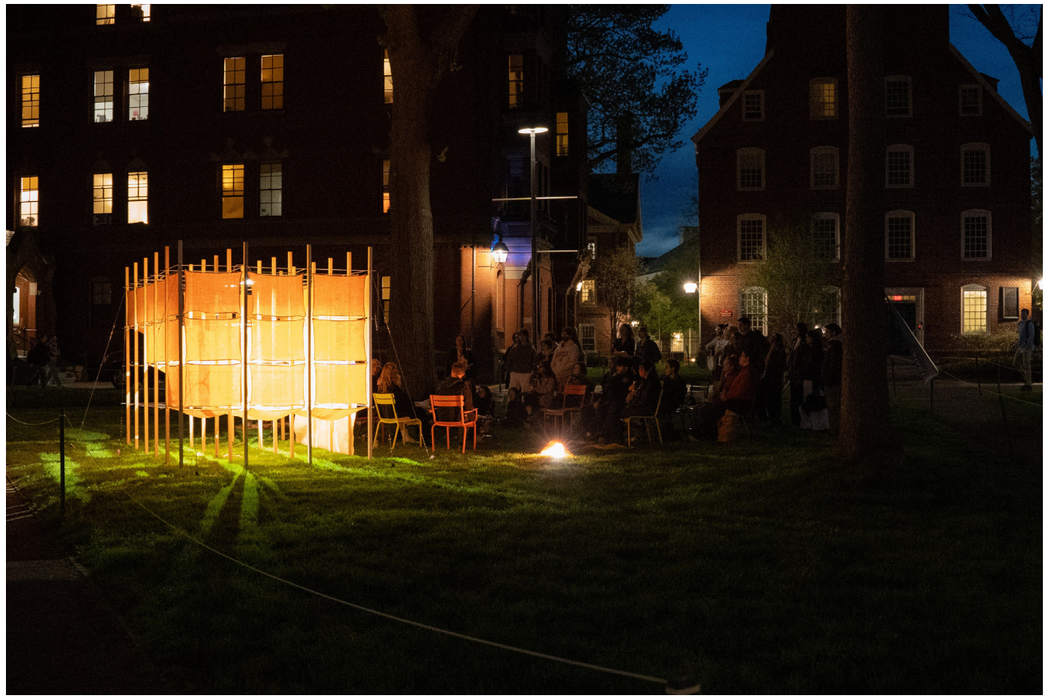
STRATA was presented in partnership with Harvard University Native American Program (HUNAP). Lead design and construction by Eric Rannestad, Ignacio Lira Montes, and Victoria Suárez as part of Malkit Shoshan's Fall 2024 course: 'Interdisciplinary Art and Design Practices' at Harvard GSD.

Eric Rannestad and James Walkingstick programmed a stickball game on the site and Kabl Wilkerson organized a talk about the Indian College and its relationship to the Harvard University today.

Eric Rannestad co-curated the film program with Jordan Clark, Director of HUNAP and obtained screening rights to the films.

Funding provided by Harvard Arts and Real Colegio Complutense at Harvard University.

STRATA, Harvard Yard. 2025



[Top] STRATA at dusk, Old Harvard Yard, May 1–4, 2025. In the evenings the structure became a screening space for films co-curated with the Harvard University Native American Program.

The film program included We Still Live Here (dir. Anne Makepeace), on the Wampanoag language reclamation movement; Dawnland, on the Wabanaki and the first government-endorsed truth and reconciliation commission in the United States; and Yintah, on the Wet'suwet'en defense of their unceded territory.

[Bottom] Eric Rannestad and Kabl Wilkerson in conversation at a talk about the Indian College and its relationship to the Harvard University today.

[Top] STRATA signage and site, Old Harvard Yard. The installation reoriented the Yard's memorialized landscape away from a memorialized european narrative and back toward Harvard's founding relationship with Indigenous North Americans and its founding charter's commitment of service to these groups.

[Bottom] Stickball in the Yard, May 1, 2025. A game organized by James Walkingstick and Eric Rannestad on the installation site, part of STRATA's public program of events, films, and discussions.

Detail from: Model 17 (almanac)
40 x 30 inches
watercolor, gouache, and ink on paper, mounted on wood panel
2026

Plots, Grids, Models

Painting

2023-2025

Plots, grids, models explores the feedback loops, histories, and efficacy of models used to control the built environment and its component networks of built and natural systems. This series explores how the 'model,' like a painting, can be a means of abstraction and artistic expression; with the artist as modeler and the painting as model.

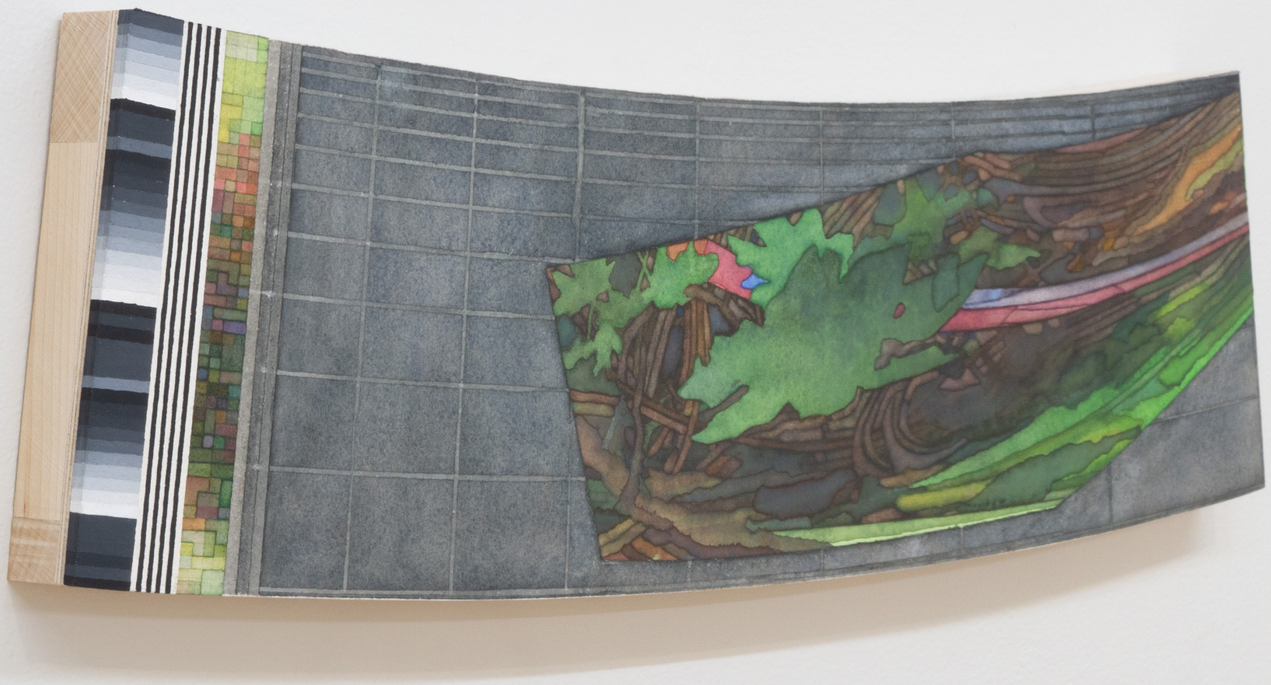
I develop these works by iteratively lifting and washing paint in relation with the emerging network of marks. This process surfaces larger forms that evoke swirling ecologies, flowers, leaves, and other networked things. Within this setting, geometric interventions are introduced, reconciled, and consumed until the composition reaches visual equilibrium.

Credits and Collaborators

Individual Project.

Ruleset Painting - Model 1
17.5 x 8 inches
watercolor, gouache, and ink on paper
2023

Flow Field - Plot 6
30 x 22 inches
watercolor and gouache on paper
2024



Model 8
21 x 6 inches
watercolor and gouache on paper, mounted on wood panel
2024

Model 9
21 x 6 inches
watercolor on paper, mounted on wood panel
2025